

Philipp Hilbert. *Platform product leader who turns infrastructure complexity into developer clarity.*

Positioning, ten years shipping B2B platform products across defence, fintech, and public infrastructure, now ready to define the primitives that power the next generation of Connect platforms.

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§ WHY STRIPE

Connect's Abstractions team is doing something rare: building not just features but the foundational vocabulary that thousands of platforms use to model their own business reality. The job description names exactly the tension I find most interesting, what should be simple by default but flexible when needed, and Stripe's track record of resolving that tension into APIs that feel inevitable is what draws me here. The AI-native platform wave described in the posting, global networks of creators, agent-driven marketplaces, participants that shift roles across borders, is precisely the kind of structural shift where weak abstractions collapse under their own weight. *That is the environment where platform primitives either compound or constrain, and where getting the design right the first time is worth everything.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, continuous pair-programming on product scaffolding
- **Lovable**, full clickable prototypes before sprint one
- **n8n**, multi-agent orchestration and agentic workflow design

- **Cursor / VSCode**, owned production code without writing it
 - **Gamma.app**, stakeholder alignment decks at speed
 - **GPT**, discovery synthesis and requirements structuring
 - **Framer**, design-heavy rapid prototyping
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Kotlin, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Kubernetes, OpenShift, ArgoCD, Helm, GitOps, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, JavaScript, Docker, Shopware, WhatsApp and Telegram messaging APIs, CGM/KIS clinical interfaces, LLM agents.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT STRIPE

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Sit with platform engineers, partnerships, and sales to map the full lifecycle of a Connect account today, where onboarding stalls, where capability configuration creates support load, and where the current abstractions force workarounds, before forming any roadmap opinion.

WEEK 2

Sharpen the primitives.

Take the roughest edges surfaced in week one, frame each as a falsifiable product bet, and run structured discovery sessions with two or three live platform users to distinguish one-off requests from recurring patterns that deserve a durable abstraction.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Drive the first focused delivery, likely a hardening or simplification of an existing onboarding primitive, from spec to launch, instrument it, and hand the team a measurement framework that makes the next decision easier than this one.

I COVER LETTER

Stripe's Connect platform sits at the intersection of two problems I have spent a decade trying to solve: how do you design infrastructure that feels simple to the builder but handles the full complexity of the real world underneath? And how do you make that infrastructure durable enough that it does not need to be rebuilt every time a new business model arrives?

At Rohde & Schwarz I owned a multimodal AI data platform for the FCAS defence programme, a system where dozens of data producers had to conform to one homogeneous training standard without losing the nuance of their source formats. The architectural challenge was identical to what Connect Abstractions faces: define primitives that are restrictive enough to guarantee interoperability but open enough that producers do not have to distort their data to fit. I moved the team away from a UI-heavy approach toward a developer-code-friendly interface and cut rollout time from days to thirty minutes. The lesson was that the right abstraction level removes friction for the sophisticated user while leaving guardrails in place for the less experienced one.

At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a public analytics platform serving labour-market data to journalists, researchers, and policymakers. The challenge there was different, not making infrastructure flexible, but making it legible. A bare-metal-to-container migration ran in parallel with a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration on Dagster and dbt, all shipped without a single data-quality incident visible to public users. What made that possible was defining success metrics before the first sprint and treating the migration as a product problem rather than a purely technical one.

Connect's next challenge, representing AI-native marketplaces and global creator networks, requires exactly this combination. Participants who shift roles, operate across borders, and need new trust mechanisms cannot be shoehorned into account abstractions designed for simpler two-sided marketplaces. The primitives need to be rethought from use cases up, not patched from the top down. I have done that kind of foundational rethinking at two different companies, and I understand both the user pressure that makes it urgent and the engineering discipline required to make the result durable.

I would welcome a conversation about how my background maps to the specific gaps you are solving right now.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Ten years of B2B platform product management across defence AI, public infrastructure, insurtech, health data, and fintech. I am at my best on products where the interface is an API or a shared platform primitive, the users are builders rather than consumers, and the design decision today shapes what the next cohort of users can build tomorrow. I move between strategic framing and hands-on execution without losing altitude on either.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product craft. Continuous discovery, prototype-led validation, outcome negotiation, backlog and release ownership, SAFe at scale, metric definition before build.

Integration and platforms. Clinical interfaces (CGM/KIS), payment and forecourt systems, e-commerce platforms (Shopware), messaging APIs (WhatsApp, Telegram), REST APIs.

Data and AI platforms. Multimodal AI training data pipelines, ETL orchestration and migration, analytics platforms for public use. Kafka, Python, Kotlin, Dagster, dbt, LLM agents.

Cloud, delivery and operations. Bare-metal to container migration, rollout and hotfix pipelines, GitOps. Kubernetes, OpenShift, Red Hat, ArgoCD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps.

AI-first building. Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Lovable for full prototyping, agent frameworks under own guardrails.

Regulated environments. Defence, public sector, health data and insurance: identity management, highest privacy requirements, audit and governance cycles.

Working tools: Jira, Confluence.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**CONSTRUCT8 · PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION MARKETPLACE,
B2B SAAS 2025 TO NOW**

Zero-to-one AI-assisted operations platform; WhatsApp and Telegram APIs, LLM agents driving autonomous field-to-back-office workflows.

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI PLATFORM (FCAS), B2B SAAS 2024 TO 2025

Unified multimodal AI training data across producers into one homogeneous standard; cut rollout from days to 30 minutes, fully hotfix-capable; steered product from UI-heavy to dev-code-friendly. Kafka, Kotlin, Python.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC ANALYTICS PLATFORM 2023 TO 2024

Public labour-market data made searchable, filterable, and social-media-ready; bare-metal-to-container migration, UI relaunch, large ETL migration shipped without user-visible incidents. Dagster, dbt.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURTECH LOW-CODE SAAS 2022

Enabled insurers to launch products in days; Claims Center launched; restructured a 17-person team into three nimble squads with accountable leads.

CLINET · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH-TECH MOBILE APP 2021 TO 2022

Native iOS/Android app; integrated the CGM/KIS clinical interface directly.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER · NATIONAL HEALTH DATA PLATFORM (RKI) 2021

RKI projects DIM and DESH: vaccination statistics and viral-mutation tracking at national scale; identity management under highest privacy requirements.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · FUEL-RETAIL INTEGRATION 2020 TO 2021

POS, payment, and forecourt systems; SAFe: PI planning and release trains.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · PROCUREMENT PLATFORM 2019 TO 2020

Full migration of a legacy webshop to Shopware for approximately 20,000 users.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · IT MODERNISATION, WIND ENERGY 2019

Full-site modernisation: end devices, servers, switches, lines, and software.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

Kvitt (mobile payments, acquired by Sparkasse) · Qcrypt (encryption, quantum-resistant) · Smart Soil Technologies (nanotech)

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · STRIPE

